

Mark Smalley

Developer Relations · Technical Evangelist · Blockchain Protocol Builder

// the rare DevRel who can write the protocol and explain it on a TED stage

Open to employed roles — UK/Europe & remote globally

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PROFILE

Developer advocate and technical evangelist with 15 years building on — and explaining — blockchain technology. One of Southeast Asia's earliest Bitcoin voices, with a track record of making complex cryptographic concepts accessible to developers, institutions, and the general public alike. Personally designed protocols now running in production (SADO, DN-Key), built open-source SDKs used across the Bitcoin Ordinals ecosystem, and currently shipping open-source game engines with full developer documentation and embed APIs. Spoken at TEDx, FinTech conferences, and developer meetups across Asia and Europe. Using AI-native engineering workflows to ship developer tooling at unprecedented pace. Looking for a DevRel or Technical Evangelist role at a Layer 1/2 protocol, developer tooling company, or infrastructure provider where both the code and the community matter.

PUBLIC CONTENT & COMMUNITY

TALKS & VIDEO

- TEDx Sarawak (2017) — 'The Cost of Cash': demystifying Bitcoin and decentralised money for a mainstream audience — on YouTube
- WebCamp KL — regular speaker from 2011; MongoDB CMS Battle (2011, YouTube, official WebCamp KL channel) and 'Introducing Bitcoin' (2013)
- Neuroware / blockchain speaker (2016, YouTube) — developer and institutional audiences on blockchain infrastructure
- Financial Crime Summit (2017), Finnovasia, MDEC FinTech Conference, Islamic Finance News Forum — regular regional speaker

WRITTEN & PUBLISHED

- 'Unravelling Blockchain's Future' — bylined article in Islamic Finance News (IFN), 2017
- 'My Life on the Blockchain' (LVLUPKL) — SlideShare, covering decentralised infrastructure evolution from 2013
- 'Banking on the Future of Blockchains' — MDEC FinTech Conference deck, widely circulated on SlideShare
- 21 technical presentations across two SlideShare profiles (2012–2018) with 59,000+ cumulative views. 'Introducing Bitcoin' (2013) alone reached 31,500+ views — among the earliest Bitcoin educational content in the region. slideshare.net/marksmalley1

OPEN SOURCE & DEVELOPER COMMUNITY

- **Moddable Chess Engine** (chess.moddable.games) — open-source game framework (v0.7.1): 70 chess variants + consumer SDK with renderer hooks, game controller, replay API, and unit templates. Dungeon Chess runs entirely on MCE as a game subsystem — proving the framework architecture. Tiered plugin system, developer guides, AI with opening books for 26 variants
- **Moddable Hexmaps** (hex.moddable.games) — open-source hex map framework (v0.5.1): 4 render styles, seeded procedural generation, URL param API, PNG/PDF/SVG export, hex metadata system, and iframe embed support for third-party integration
- **SADO Protocol** (github.com/sadoprotocol) — co-authored open-source, self-authenticating decentralised order-book for Bitcoin Ordinals; adopted by Ordzaar and third-party exchanges
- **Ordit SDK** — open-source indexer, parser, and API toolkit for Ordinals and Inscriptions; ~50K npm downloads, multiple repos under sadoprotocol.org
- **DN-Key Protocol** — authored decentralised key management via DNS TXT records; adopted by ATA Plus ECF (2016), cited in SC Malaysia's capital markets blueprint (2018), reused in Oviato's identity layer (2025)
- **Everstore Protocol** — complete on-chain relational database via BIP32 key derivation: CRUD, encryption, indexing, audit trails (2016, pre-EVM; 25-page whitepaper); featured in Blockchain Finance
- **BackPress** — core contributor to Automattic's BackPress framework (WordPress ecosystem)
- Regular speaker at **WebCamp KL** from 2011 — one of Malaysia's earliest web and blockchain developer communities
- Founded and operated the **Blockchain Embassy of Asia** — ASEAN's first public blockchain consortium

WORK EXPERIENCE

Chief Blockchain Officer Oviato — United Kingdom

Feb 2025 – Mar 2026

Co-founded passkey-native wallet infrastructure startup. Built on Project Eden prototype (weekend hackathon → production). Contributed to the developer narrative and technical positioning that secured DraperVC investment.

- Built internal cryptographic and passkey/WebAuthN framework — designed for developer-friendly integration by third-party wallet builders
- Articulated complex infrastructure concepts clearly to non-technical investors and partners during the DraperVC fundraising
- Designed prototypes demonstrating WebAuthN's viability for consumer-grade, non-custodial wallet UX

Open-source games studio shipping developer-facing engines, documentation, and tools — built entirely using AI-augmented engineering workflows. Evolved the chess engine into a consumer game framework (v0.7.1) now powering two games from the same core.

- Evolved [Moddable Chess](#) from a 70-variant chess engine into a consumer game SDK — createGameController(), createReplay(), renderer extension hooks (tilePainter, pieceProvider), unit templates, and terrain predicates
- Built [Dungeon Chess](#) entirely on MCE's consumer APIs — asymmetric skirmish game with 4 factions, custom renderer hooks, and AI. Proves the framework powers non-chess games without engine forks
- Wrote developer documentation spanning plugins (Build a Variant, Crazyhouse, Poison Chess) and consumer integration (Building Dungeon Chess guide) — enabling both variant authors and game builders
- Published [Moddable Hexmaps](#) (v0.5.1) with 4 render styles, procedural generation, URL param API, PNG/PDF/SVG export, and hex metadata system. Built PDF pagination engine for 190+ page rulebook libraries
- Built the entire product suite using LLM-driven development — demonstrating AI-native engineering workflows and framework-level architecture at production scale

Sole developer of Ordzaar prototype; co-authored the SADO open protocol standard and its public SDK — a significant open-source contribution to the Bitcoin developer ecosystem.

- Personally built the first Ordzaar prototype — now the leading Bitcoin Ordinals marketplace and CakeDefi's fifth business vertical
- Co-authored SADO Protocol and led the open-source SDK release at [github.com/sadoprotocol](#) — making Ordinals tooling accessible to the developer community
- Promoted from P4 Engineer to M3 Manager; deepened expertise in Schnorr, Taproot, Ordinals, Inscriptions, Runes

Led Malaysia's foremost blockchain infrastructure practice — building products, educating developers and institutions, and shaping the regulatory environment for digital assets in Southeast Asia.

- Authored all curriculum and materials for the StartingBlock Tour (2015) — blockchain developer workshops delivered across 6 European cities in 8 days (Istanbul, Amsterdam, Barcelona, Prague, Berlin, London)
- Ran DBS Bank hackathon infrastructure — 1M+ API requests processed; 7 of 15 teams built on our stack
- Distributed 100+ developer 'hack-pack' USB drives pre-loaded with blockchain tooling across global workshop events
- Authored technical whitepapers, protocol specifications (DN-Key, SADO), and developer documentation
- Delivered training to DBS Bank (Singapore) and Baker Hostetler (USA); contributed to Malaysia's Digital Asset regulatory roadmap

500 Startups Batch 9 (US\$300K+ raised, launched at TechCrunch Disrupt London). Built and promoted open-source wallet and SDK tooling. Featured on CoinDesk and BFM Radio.

- Authored Everstore protocol (2016, 25-page whitepaper) — complete relational database engine on UTXO chains before EVM existed; emerged from DBS hackathon constraints, featured in Blockchain Finance
- Built open-source blockchain wallet framework — the only one with themes and plugins, targeting mainstream developers rather than blockchain specialists
- Two live BFM Radio appearances (2016) — Malaysia's English business radio — explaining blockchain to mainstream audiences
- Core contributor to Automattic's BackPress framework — meaningful contribution to a major open-source ecosystem

TECHNICAL STACK

Bitcoin	UTXO scripting, Schnorr/Taproot, Ordinals, Inscriptions, Runes, BRC-20, BitcoinJS, SADO SDK
Ethereum	Solidity, EthersJS, Web3.js, ERC-20, ERC-721, IPFS, smart contract design
Auth	Passkeys, WebAuthN, FIDO2, DN-Key, cryptographic key management
Backend	Node.js, MongoDB, Neo4j, REST APIs, SDK design, open-source library development
Frontend	React, Svelte, VueJS, Tailwind, ThreeJS, WebGL, Canvas, SVG
AI	LLM-augmented development workflows, AI game engines, procedural generation, prompt engineering
Content	Technical writing, whitepaper authorship, developer guides, live demos, workshop facilitation

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

- TEDx speaker (2017) — one of the earliest mainstream Bitcoin talks in Southeast Asia
 - StartingBlock 2015 — authored workshop curriculum delivered across 6 European cities in 8 days
 - Deloitte Top 50 Global RegTech & Digerati50
- DraperVC investment at Oviato — technical work directly contributed to funding outcome
 - First Bitcoin talk at WebCamp KL (2013) — among the earliest blockchain developer presentations in Southeast Asia
 - 500 Startups Batch 9 and Antler Malaysia Batch 2

CREDENTIALS

Registered HRDF Trainer	500 Startups Batch 9 · Antler Malaysia Batch 2
Core contributor — Automattic BackPress (WordPress)	Silver Duke of Edinburgh Award

REFERENCES

Shafiu Hussain

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U-Zyn Chua

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